NORTHWIND LABS EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

1. Welcome to Northwind

This handbook explains how we work at Northwind Labs: our hours, pay, benefits and the practical things every employee needs to know. Specific policies, such as the Leave Policy and the Code of Conduct, are published separately and take precedence where they go into more detail.

2. Working Hours

Our standard working hours are 8:30 to 17:00, Monday to Friday, with a one-hour lunch break. Claims and customer support teams work a rota that includes some Saturday mornings; your manager will share the rota a month in advance.

Northwind works in a hybrid model. Employees based in Lagos or Abuja are expected in the office on Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Thursdays. Monday and Friday are flexible days that you may work from home.

3. Probation

New employees serve a six-month probation period. Your line manager will hold a check-in at three months and a confirmation review at six months.

4. Pay and Payslips

Salaries are paid monthly on the 25th. If the 25th falls on a weekend or public holiday, salaries are paid on the previous working day. Payslips are available in the PeopleHub portal.

Northwind deducts 8% of your monthly emoluments for your pension, and Northwind contributes a further 10%, paid to the Pension Fund Administrator you choose, in line with the Pension Reform Act.

5. Health Insurance

Every employee is covered by Northwind Health, our own HMO plan, from their first day. Cover includes the employee, a spouse and up to four children under 18. It covers outpatient consultations, prescribed drugs, hospital admission, maternity care and basic dental and optical care. It does not cover cosmetic procedures.

6. Time Off

Annual leave entitlements are set out in the Leave Policy.

6.4 Requesting Time Off

Request time off in the PeopleHub portal and let your line manager know. Your manager approves requests in the portal. Please plan leave around month-end closing if you work in Finance or Claims.

6.7 Sickness Absence

Staff may take up to ten (10) working days of paid sick leave in a calendar year. Further absence is unpaid unless agreed with People & Culture.

7. Equipment and Access

Every employee receives a laptop on their first day. To get access to internal tools, such as the claims dashboard or the underwriting system, raise a request with the IT helpdesk at it@northwindlabs.example and copy your line manager, who approves it.

8. Learning and Development

Each employee has a learning budget of 150,000 naira per year for courses, certifications and books related to their role. Employees studying for professional insurance exams (CIIN) receive three days of paid study leave per exam.